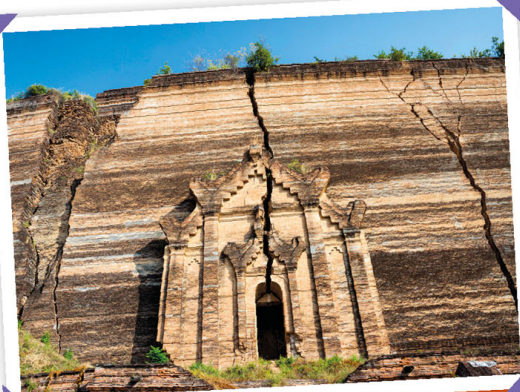


Italy 2009

In 2009, an earthquake measuring 6.3 on a seismograph struck L'Aquila in central Italy. Many buildings collapsed and around 300 people died. Thousands of smaller earthquakes, called aftershocks, followed.



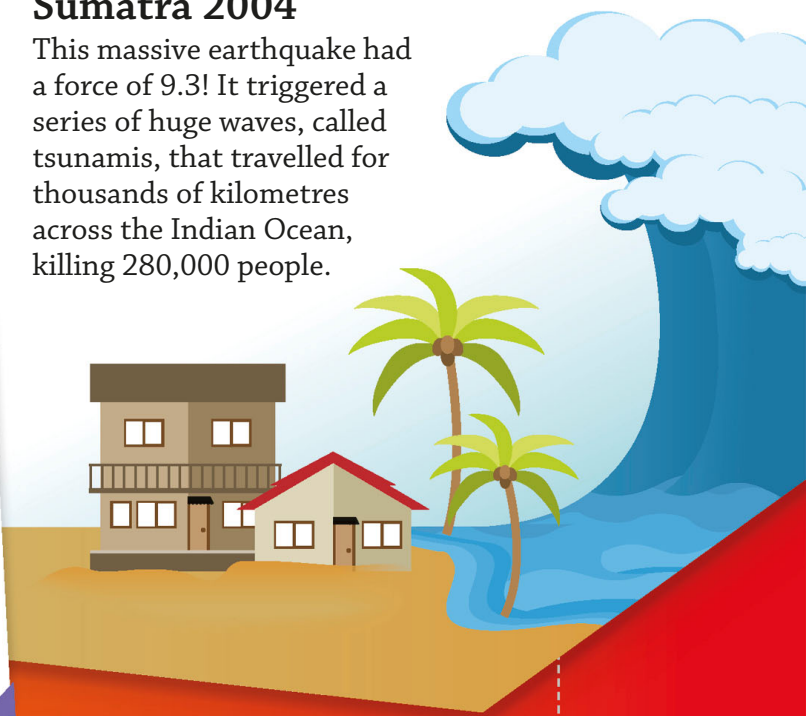
6.3

Wobbling dishes

When an earthquake has a force of 5–6, windows are likely to crack and dishes fall off shelves and smash. Some buildings may suffer serious damage.

Sumatra 2004

This massive earthquake had a force of 9.3! It triggered a series of huge waves, called tsunamis, that travelled for thousands of kilometres across the Indian Ocean, killing 280,000 people.



7.9

9.3



China 2008

A force-8 earthquake struck Sichuan Province, China, in 2008. Huge chunks of rock fell down from the mountains, smashing towns and villages. Tremors were felt up to 1,700 km (1,060 miles) away.